



PARISH NEWSLETTER

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Fr Micheál McGavigan PP – Fr Roni Zacharias CC – Fr Stephen Ward CC

Sunday 13th September 2026 – Twenty Fourth Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A

In this Sunday's Gospel, Peter asks a question many of us have asked: *"How often must I forgive?"* Jesus' answer invites us to stop keeping score and to live instead from mercy. In the parable of the unforgiving servant, he shows that we have received far more forgiveness from God than we could ever earn. This week we reflect on the link between forgiveness and freedom. Forgiveness does not excuse wrongdoing, but it prevents resentment taking root in our hearts. Holding onto bitterness can imprison us more than the person who hurt us. The Lord invites us to let go of old grievances and allow his grace to heal our wounds. True forgiveness is not weakness, but an act of freedom born of God's mercy.

WELCOME TO GOD'S FAMILY

Aúrórá-Océán McGillian; Zac O'Neill; Anastasia Barton-Fisher; Sean Óg Lafferty.

REQUIESCAT IN PACE

We offer our sympathies to the family and friends of: Thomas Morrison, Aberfoyle Crescent.

ANNIVERSARIES

Billy McGreanery; Paddy Moore; Tony Burksfield; Malachy Williamson; John & Sheila Quigley; John Clifford; Derek Seymour; Bridie & John Canning; Nadine Gallagher; Elizabeth Breslin.

CHILDREN'S LITURGY

Will begin again next Sunday, 20th September, in our three churches. We welcome children from P1-4. where they will take part in an activity themed on Sunday's Gospel

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS

In today's gospel Jesus teaches a powerful lesson on forgiveness. We pray for the men called to priesthood that, as they celebrate the Sacrament of Reconciliation with their people, they will help them to know and experience the Lord who "...is compassion and love, slow to anger, and rich in mercy." (Responsorial Psalm).

READINGS FOR SUNDAY 20th SEPTEMBER

1st: Isaiah 55:6-9 Psalm: 144:2-3, 8-9, 17-18, R/v 18.
2nd: Philippians 1:20-24, 27. Gospel: Matthew 20: 1-6.

LECTIO DIVINA ON SUNDAY'S GOSPEL

Take some time to pray, reflect and share as we explore the Gospel for the coming Sunday. Beginning Monday 21st Sept after the 10am Mass in the Emmaus Room, Pennyburn.

THREE PATRONS MONTHLY CASH PRIZE DRAW

November: 5 x £100; 1 x £500; Top Prize £1,000. December: 5 x £100; 1 x £500; JUMBO PRIZE £2,000. Tickets cost £20. Monthly promoter prize of £50 for each winning ticket. Tickets are available from Church sacristies and Parish Offices. Card payments available at the Pennyburn Parish Office. Draws take place Friday, 20th October & Friday 18th December.

TRIDUUM OF MASSES FOR BISHOP MICHAEL ROUTER

As we prepare to celebrate the Installation of Bishop Michael Router as Bishop of Derry on Sunday 20 September, a Triduum of Masses will be celebrated in parishes throughout the diocese. In our parish, these Masses will be celebrated on Friday 18th at 10am in St Patrick's Church, Pennyburn, on Saturday 19th at 11am in St Brigid's Church, Carnhill, and on Sunday 20th at 11am in St Joseph's Church, Galliagh. All are welcome to attend as we pray for Bishop Router.

LEGION OF MARY BUS TO KNOCK

On Sunday 27th September leaving St Joseph's Church at 8am. Cost: £25 includes tea/scones on way. To book a place, telephone 07999661491 or call into St Joseph's Church 9am – 1pm Monday to Friday.

SIMPLE FAMILY PRAYER BOOK

This Sunday begins psalter week 4.

LAST WEEK'S OFFERTORY COLLECTION

St Patrick's Church: £1,467 - St Brigid's Church: £2,131 - St Joseph's Church: £1,070

2nd Collection (Maintenance & Pastoral Outreach): £1,193.

Thank you for your continued generosity.

BANK DETAILS FOR ONLINE DONATIONS: A/C Name: The Parish of the Three Patrons

Sort Code: 95-06-79 A/C No: 60320021

THE CARE FOR CREATION GROUP

'We have forgotten that we ourselves are dust of the earth (Gen. 2: 7); our very bodies are made up of her elements; we breathe her air and we receive life and refreshment from her waters.' (Pope Francis: LS 2). As part of the Season of Creation, the parish will be displaying a piece of artwork in the three churches over the coming weeks: 12th Sept in St Patrick's Church; 19th Sept in St Brigid's Church; and 26th Sept in St Joseph's Church.

NEW WOMEN'S WALKING GROUP

All ages welcomed. Approximately 1 hour walk. Feel safe in the dark evenings, have a chat, meet your neighbours. Starts Wed 23rd Sept at 7pm and every Wednesday thereafter. Meeting point: Top of Gleneagles, Culmore Rd.

HOST FOR HOSPICE

We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning in October. To request your free host pack or for more info, please call Ailbhe McDaid, on 028 7135 9888 or email: ailbhe@foylehospice.com

PRIVACY NOTICE

The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations, and a privacy notice is available on the Parish website or by contacting the Parish Office. Livestream and recordings of Mass and services in our Churches are available online. Please note that the front rows of seats are visible online.

THE COLUMBAN YOUNG ADULTS

Are a new group for those aged 18 - 30 in the diocese, who are seeking a community of like-minded young adults who have Christ at the centre of their lives. Our September event will be a Holy Hour and meditation, followed by benediction and refreshments on Thursday 17 September, 7pm at our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown.

QUEEN'S UNIVERSITY CATHOLIC CHAPLAINCY

Reopens on Monday 14 September with weekday Masses and semester activities resuming. Our first Sunday Mass will be on 20 September at the new time of 7.00pm. New and returning students can find details of events, accommodation at Ryan Hall, and ways to get involved at qubcatholic.org and on our social media channels. Staff and alumni are always welcome. Visit the newly renewed Chaplaincy at 28 Elmwood Avenue for Mass, Confessions, or quiet prayer, and call into Mosaic for coffee, lunches, and home-baked treats.

FAITH IN FIRE

An exhibition from the Persecuted Church in Nigeria will be held in Christ Church 14-20 September, 10.30am - 4.00pm each day. Admission free. All welcome.

SAFEGUARDING

If you have any concerns about the Safeguarding of Children or vulnerable adults within the Church, please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596500793 or at dlp@derrydiocese.org

PARISH GROUPS & MEETINGS

Monday	After 11am Mass 1pm – 2.30pm 7pm – 8.30pm 7pm - 9pm	Holy Souls Prayer Group Legion of Mary Carnhill Folk Group Woman's Craft Group	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh Meeting Room, St Joseph's Church, Galliagh St Brigid's Church, Carnhill Kildare Room, Carnhill
Tuesday	After 11am Mass 11.30am - 2.30pm 12pm – 1pm 7.30pm - 9.30pm	Devotion to the Holy Face St. Pio's Café Reflection on Sunday Scriptures Living Disciples Prayer Group	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh St Pio Centre, Galliagh St Pio Centre, Galliagh St Pio Centre, Galliagh
Thursday	11.30am - 2.30pm 4.45pm – 5.30pm 6pm – 7pm 7pm – 8pm 7.30pm - 8.30pm 8.15pm – 10pm	St. Pio's Café St Brigid's Youth Choir Divine Will Prayer Group Holy Hour for the Unborn Youth Prayer Group Be Still – Men's Prayer Group	St. Pio Centre, Galliagh St Brigid's Church, Carnhill Kildare Room, Carnhill Our Lady's Chapel St. Pio Centre, Galliagh Our Lady's Chapel
Friday	11.30am-12.30pm	Divine Mercy Prayer Group	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh

PARISH SCHEDULE

ST PATRICK'S CHURCH, PENNYBURN

Sunday Mass:	Vigil 6.15pm; 9.45am
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 10am; Wednesday: 7pm
Confessions:	Wednesday: 6.15pm – 6.45pm; Saturday: 5.15pm – 6pm
Eucharistic Adoration:	Wednesday: 10.30am – 4pm in the Emmaus Room
Baptisms:	Saturday: 4.30pm; Sunday: 1.30pm

ST BRIGID'S CHURCH, CARNHILL

Sunday Mass:	Vigil 5pm; 10.30am & 12.30pm
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 9.30am; Thursday: 7pm; Saturday: 11am
Confessions:	Thursday: 6.15pm – 6.45pm; Saturday after 11.00am Mass and 4pm - 4.45pm
Eucharistic Adoration:	Daily: 8.00am – 8.00pm in St Carlo Acutis Chapel
Baptisms:	Saturday: 3.30pm

ST JOSEPH'S CHURCH, GALLIAGH

Sunday Mass:	11.00am; 12.30pm (<i>An tAifreann Naofa</i>); 6.30pm
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 11am; Tuesday: 7pm
Confessions:	Tuesday: 6.15pm – 6.45pm; Sunday: 5.30pm – 6.15pm
Eucharistic Adoration:	Tuesday: 11.30am – 7.00pm in Our Lady's Chapel
Baptisms:	Saturday: 3.30pm